

BTEC Level 3 Health and Social Care

Unit 2: Working in Health and Social Care

Exam Walkthrough | Paper 31491H | Session: June 2023

How to answer every question · step by step

Command words · what the examiner wants

Identify / State (2 marks) · Give TWO brief, correct points. No explanation needed · just name or state two relevant things. 1 mark per point.

Describe (4 marks) · Give TWO points, each with a little detail. Two developed points = 4 marks (2 marks each).

Explain (6 marks) · Give THREE points, each explained (a point + a reason or effect). Three developed points = 6 marks (2 marks each).

Discuss (8 marks) · Give a BALANCED argument: several developed points PLUS a 'however' counterpoint. Four developed points = 8 marks (2 marks each).

Question 1 (a)

Identify two protected characteristics covered by the Equality Act 2010. (2)

Command word: Identify

How to approach: Recall the protected characteristics · age, disability, race, sex, religion/belief, etc.

Model answer:

- Age / disability / race / sex / religion or belief (any two).

Why it earns the marks: One mark per correct characteristic. Two valid characteristics earn the full 2 marks.

Question 1 (b)

Describe two skills the community psychiatric nurse needs to demonstrate when working with Paul. (4)

Command word: Describe

How to approach: Think of two interpersonal skills · communication/active listening, and empathy/patience.

Model answer:

- Communication and active listening skills.
- Empathy and patience.

Why it earns the marks: Two marks per skill: one for naming it, one for the detail. Link each to working with Paul.

Question 1 (c)

Explain how the psychiatric nurse can be supported by their line manager. (6)

Command word: Explain

How to approach: Think of three ways a line manager supports staff · supervision/feedback, training/CPD, and emotional support/workload management.

Model answer:

- Providing supervision, guidance and feedback.
- Providing training and CPD opportunities.
- Offering emotional support and managing workload.

Why it earns the marks: Three developed points, 2 marks each. Each point states a support and its purpose.

Question 1 (d)

Discuss how health and social care staff can support Paul to improve his health and wellbeing. (8)

Command word: Discuss

How to approach: Give three ways staff support Paul (holistic care, access to services, promoting independence), then a 'however' about dependence on engagement/resources.

Model answer:

- Providing holistic, person-centred care that considers all of Paul's needs.
- Supporting Paul to access services and support.
- Promoting Paul's independence and empowering him.
- However, improvement depends on Paul's engagement and the resources available.

Why it earns the marks: Four developed points at 2 marks each. The 'however' point (dependence on engagement/resources) provides the balance a Discuss needs.

Question 2 (a)

Identify two aspects of personal care that may be provided. (2)

Command word: Identify

How to approach: Recall aspects of personal care · washing, dressing, toileting, feeding.

Model answer:

- Washing / dressing / toileting / feeding (any two).

Why it earns the marks: One mark per correct aspect. Two valid aspects earn the full 2 marks.

Question 2 (b)

Describe two reasons why risk assessments should be carried out. (4)

Command word: Describe

How to approach: Think of two reasons · to identify/reduce hazards, and to protect people/meet legal requirements.

Model answer:

- To identify and reduce hazards and risks.
- To protect service users and staff, and meet legal requirements.

Why it earns the marks: Two marks per reason: one for the reason, one for the detail. Link each to the purpose of risk assessment.

Question 2 (c)

Explain how the day care centre can adapt its provision to meet the beliefs and cultures of service users. (6)

Command word: Explain

How to approach: Think of three adaptations · respecting dietary requirements, accommodating religious practices, and cultural awareness training.

Model answer:

- Respecting dietary requirements and food preferences.
- Accommodating religious practices and observances.
- Training staff in cultural awareness and sensitivity.

Why it earns the marks: Three developed points, 2 marks each. Each point states an adaptation and how it meets cultural needs.

Question 2 (d)

Discuss the actions you may take in response to the disclosure. (8)

Command word: Discuss

How to approach: This is a safeguarding disclosure. Give three actions (listen/reassure, record, report to safeguarding lead), then a 'however' about not investigating yourself.

Model answer:

- Listening carefully and reassuring the person, without promising confidentiality.
- Recording the disclosure accurately and factually.
- Reporting the disclosure to the designated safeguarding lead.
- However, you must follow procedures and not investigate the matter yourself.

Why it earns the marks: Four developed points at 2 marks each. The 'however' point (do not investigate yourself) is the balanced, correct safeguarding response.

Question 3 (a)

Identify two health settings that can support Olena with pain management. (2)

Command word: Identify

How to approach: Think of two settings for pain management · hospital, hospice, GP surgery, pain clinic.

Model answer:

- Hospital / hospice / GP surgery / pain clinic (any two).

Why it earns the marks: One mark per correct setting. Two valid settings earn the full 2 marks.

Question 3 (b)

Describe two ways the care assistant should maintain confidentiality when working with Olena. (4)

Command word: Describe

How to approach: Think of two confidentiality practices · not discussing information inappropriately, and storing records securely.

Model answer:

- Not discussing Olena's information inappropriately with others.
- Storing Olena's records securely and confidentially.

Why it earns the marks: Two marks per way: one for the practice, one for the detail. Link each to maintaining confidentiality.

Question 3 (c)

Explain how she can be supported in a work environment to take account of her needs. (6)

Command word: Explain

How to approach: Think of three workplace supports · reasonable adjustments, flexible working, and supportive management/training.

Model answer:

- Making reasonable adjustments to the work environment.
- Offering flexible working arrangements.
- Providing supportive management and appropriate training.

Why it earns the marks: Three developed points, 2 marks each. Each point states a support and how it meets her needs.

Question 3 (d)

Discuss the possible disadvantages of multidisciplinary working when carrying out care and support planning for Olena. (8)

Command word: Discuss

How to approach: Give three disadvantages (communication difficulties, conflicting advice, time/cost), then a 'however' about how they can be managed.

Model answer:

- Communication difficulties between professionals can cause delays.
- Conflicting advice from different professionals can confuse Olena.
- Multidisciplinary working can be time-consuming and costly.
- However, these disadvantages can be managed through clear communication and coordination.

Why it earns the marks: Four developed points at 2 marks each. The 'however' point (disadvantages can be managed) provides the balance a Discuss needs.

Question 4 (a)

Identify two health professionals who may work with children up to the age of five years. (2)

Command word: Identify

How to approach: Think of two professionals working with young children · health visitor, midwife, paediatrician, GP.

Model answer:

- Health visitor / midwife / paediatrician / GP (any two).

Why it earns the marks: One mark per correct professional. Two valid roles earn the full 2 marks.

Question 4 (b)

Describe two procedures that should be followed when dealing with hazardous waste. (4)

Command word: Describe

How to approach: Think of two procedures · correct disposal containers, and COSHH/PPE/training.

Model answer:

- Disposing of waste in the correct designated containers.
- Following COSHH procedures, using PPE and receiving training.

Why it earns the marks: Two marks per procedure: one for the procedure, one for the detail. Link each to safe waste handling.

Question 4 (c)

Explain how financial and emotional barriers may prevent parents accessing the support offered by the centre. (6)

Command word: Explain

How to approach: Explain BOTH barrier types · financial (cost of travel/childcare) and emotional (stigma/fear/anxiety), and how they reduce access.

Model answer:

- Financial barriers · the cost of travel or childcare may prevent access.
- Emotional barriers · stigma, fear or anxiety may discourage parents.
- Both types of barrier reduce parents' ability to access support.

Why it earns the marks: Three developed points, 2 marks each. You must cover BOTH financial and emotional barriers, and link them to reduced access.

Question 4 (d)

Discuss how the manager of the centre may improve the standard of care in response to the inspection report. (8)

Command word: Discuss

How to approach: Give three improvement actions (action plan, staff training, monitoring progress), then a 'however' about resource demands.

Model answer:

- Developing an action plan to address the findings of the inspection.
- Providing staff training to improve standards.
- Monitoring and reviewing progress against the action plan.
- However, improvement requires resources and sustained commitment from the organisation.

Why it earns the marks: Four developed points at 2 marks each. The 'however' point (resource demands) provides the balance a Discuss needs.
